

Palmfire Operating Roadmap

Palmfire production and distribution system

Operating model

Palmfire uses four linked stages:

- Human story direction - premise, characters, world, genre, beginning and ending.
- Agent story development - outline, screenplay, continuity and scene packages.
- Human-led production - visual generation, voice, editing, captions and quality control.
- Distribution and learning - free discovery content, paid access, marketing and measurement.

Agents should move a project forward, not create an invisible chain of unapproved decisions.

Stage 1: human story brief

The human provides:

- working title;
- logline or simple premise;
- genre and tone;
- intended audience and age rating;
- setting, time period and cultural context;
- main characters;
- what each main character wants;
- beginning, major turn and ending;
- themes or questions;
- boundaries and exclusions;
- references for mood, not material to copy;
- desired language and approximate runtime.

The human may describe the story conversationally. The story agent must convert it into a structured brief before writing scenes.

Stage 2: agent story development

Story architect

Create the story spine:

- logline;
- central dramatic question;
- character wants and needs;
- stakes and consequences;
- beginning, escalation, midpoint, crisis and ending;
- episode-by-episode arc;
- continuity risks;
- unresolved questions.

Stop for human approval before writing the full screenplay.

Scriptwriter

Turn the approved story spine into a production-ready screenplay. Use standard screenplay elements: scene headings, present-tense action, character cues, dialogue, limited parentheticals and sparing transitions.

The scriptwriter follows a reusable dialogue pass rather than waiting for a human to line-edit every episode:

- give each scene one or two memorable lines at most; let the surrounding dialogue be plain, specific and functional;
- vary sentence shape and deflection style by character; do not repeat a grammatical device such as "That is not..." or "I did not say..." across scenes;
- allow silence, unfinished thoughts, failed jokes, physical action and unresolved answers;
- when a line carries real comedy or emotional history, build a short conversation around it with a question, pushback or detail before moving on;
- protect the character's point of view: wit should reveal pressure, intimacy or status, not exist only to sound clever;
- after drafting, read the dialogue aloud or use a rough voice pass and mark any exchange that sounds too symmetrical, too fast or too perfectly answered.

This pass is a production gate. A human may approve the result at the outline or sample-scene stage, but the agent should apply these checks consistently to the full draft.

For a 30-minute episode, use six sequences of about five minutes each. Each sequence should contain two to four scenes. A scene should normally be one to three minutes, with shorter scenes when a sharp cut

improves pacing.

The scriptwriter must include:

- scene purpose;
- conflict or change;
- character objective;
- visual action;
- dialogue;
- sound or music cues where important;
- approximate runtime;
- continuity notes;
- a clear transition into the next scene.

Continuity reviewer

Check:

- character names and ages;
- physical descriptions;
- timeline and geography;
- objects and injuries;
- who knows what and when;
- cause and effect;
- episode hooks and payoffs;
- consistency with the story bible.

Scene planner

Convert each approved scene into a production packet:

- sequence ID;
- scene ID;
- runtime target;
- location and time of day;
- characters present;
- emotional objective;

- shot list;
- framing and camera movement;
- character and wardrobe continuity;
- visual style and lighting;
- dialogue and sound requirements;
- generation prompts;
- negative prompts and exclusions;
- required reference images;
- edit notes.

Stage 3: production

Produce in this order:

- lock the script;
- create the character and location reference sheet;
- generate stills and select a consistent visual direction;
- generate only the motion shots that materially improve the scene;
- record or generate dialogue;
- add music, ambience and sound effects;
- edit the episode;
- add captions and credits;
- run continuity, rights and safety checks;
- obtain human release approval.

Use one primary visual style per season. Do not change models in the middle of an episode unless the difference is intentional.

Stage 4: distribution

Free discovery

- YouTube trailer;
- first episode or selected opening sequence;
- Shorts and vertical excerpts;
- Facebook video posts and paid tests;

- still posters and short character clips;
- email or WhatsApp announcement when practical.

Paid access

The Palmfire website should sell a 24-hour, seven-day or 30-day access pass through one-time Paystack checkout. The viewer receives a temporary entitlement and a signed playback link.

Marketing loop

Every campaign must have a source label. Record:

- source platform;
- creative variant;
- landing-page visits;
- checkout starts;
- successful payments;
- repeat purchases;
- episode completion.

Do not scale an advert because it receives cheap views. Scale it only when paying-user value exceeds acquisition and direct content cost.

Episode structure

Each 30-minute episode should have:

- a hook in the first minute;
- six five-minute sequences;
- one central objective;
- escalating obstacles;
- a midpoint change;
- a decisive final movement;
- an ending that resolves the episode while creating a reason to watch the next one.

Free-to-paid conversion rule

For a five-episode series, Episodes 1 and 2 are the free discovery release. Episodes 3-5 are the paid continuation. The end of Episode 2 must therefore land on a pivotal story change: a major revelation,

irreversible choice, betrayal, loss, threat or new obligation that materially changes what the protagonist can do next.

The Episode 2 cliffhanger must:

- be earned by the events of Episodes 1-2;
- create an urgent unanswered question;
- preserve enough mystery that the paid episodes still have discoveries to make;
- change the emotional or practical stakes, not merely stop during an ordinary scene;
- be tested in the season outline before Episode 2 is scripted.

This is a release rule for every Palmfire series, not just the first pilot. The story architect must label the Episode 2 conversion beat in the season map, and the continuity reviewer must verify that the preceding scenes build toward it.

Pilot roadmap

Phase 0 - foundation

- approve Palmfire ethos;
- create the story brief template;
- create the scriptwriting skill;
- create the character, location and rights logs;
- build a minimal landing page and payment test;
- verify RealWay hosting and Paystack webhooks.

Phase 1 - episode one

- approve the five-episode season brief;
- outline all five episodes;
- write and review episode one;
- create scene packets;
- produce a small visual test before generating the whole episode.

Before production begins, also identify the Episode 2 conversion beat and confirm that the Episode 1 ending points toward it without giving away the season mystery.

Phase 2 - release test

- publish a trailer and a free opening;
- release the paid episode on the Palmfire site;
- test ■200, ■1,000 and ■3,000 access options;
- run a capped Facebook campaign;
- record payment and completion behaviour.

Phase 3 - episodes two to five

Continue only if the first episode produces evidence of payment, repeat viewing or strong organic demand. Reuse the established visual bible to reduce generation cost.

Phase 4 - systemisation

- turn repeated prompts into templates;
- create scene and continuity checklists;
- record successful production actions;
- automate metadata, captions and publishing preparation;
- retain human approval for final scripts, spending and release.

Go/no-go metrics

Review after the first paid release:

- cost per finished minute;
- paid conversion from qualified visitors;
- average order value;
- repeat purchase rate;
- episode completion;
- customer acquisition cost;
- direct revenue minus generation, payment and advertising costs.

If viewers watch but do not pay, improve the offer or the funnel before increasing generation spend. If viewers pay and return, invest in quality and production speed.